

Part III — Editorial Capabilities

1. Purpose

The Editorial Domain Model defines what exists within the Wardle Editorial Operating System.

Editorial Capabilities define what the system must enable editors to accomplish.

Capabilities describe enduring editorial functions rather than software features.

They remain valid regardless of changes in user interface, implementation technology, or workflow design.

Every capability represents a core responsibility of WEOS in governing clinical knowledge.

No implementation should exist without supporting at least one editorial capability.

2. Capability Philosophy

WEOS is not organised around pages or administrative tools.

It is organised around editorial work.

Editors do not think in terms of viewing database entities.

Editors think in terms of completing meaningful editorial tasks.

Examples include:

- Create a diagnosis.
- Review a clinical case.
- Improve diagnostic reasoning.
- Approve a teaching objective.
- Validate a graph relationship.
- Publish educational knowledge.

Editorial capabilities therefore describe the work performed by clinicians rather than the software used to perform it.

3. Capability Categories

WEOS capabilities are organised into six major domains.

These domains collectively describe the complete lifecycle of clinical knowledge.

Knowledge Creation

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Knowledge Development

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Editorial Review

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Knowledge Governance

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Publication

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Continuous Improvement

Each domain contains multiple editorial capabilities.

4. Knowledge Creation

Knowledge creation establishes new editorial artifacts.

Creation may occur through human authoring, AI-assisted generation, or structured editorial workflows.

Knowledge creation does not imply publication.

Every newly created artifact enters editorial governance.

Core capabilities include:

- Diagnosis registration
- Metadata authoring
- Educational scaffold generation
- Clinical case authoring
- Educational content authoring
- Knowledge relationship creation
- Reference acquisition
- AI-assisted draft generation

The purpose of creation is to establish candidate knowledge for editorial evaluation.

5. Knowledge Development

Development improves existing knowledge.

Unlike creation, development assumes that an editorial artifact already exists.

Development capabilities include:

- Revising educational content
- Improving clinical reasoning
- Refining clue progression
- Expanding differential diagnoses
- Improving teaching objectives
- Updating teaching rules
- Strengthening clinical pearls
- Revising management guidance
- Expanding investigation guidance
- Improving educational consistency

Knowledge development is expected to continue throughout the lifetime of every artifact.

6. Editorial Review

Editorial review evaluates whether an artifact satisfies clinical and educational expectations.

Review does not create knowledge.

Review establishes confidence.

Review capabilities include:

- Clinical correctness review
- Educational quality review
- Diagnostic reasoning review
- Knowledge graph review
- Differential review
- Teaching objective review
- Teaching rule review
- Clinical pearl review
- Evidence review
- AI draft review
- Publication readiness review

Every review produces an explicit editorial decision.

Review never silently modifies knowledge.

7. Knowledge Governance

Governance maintains the integrity of the editorial ecosystem.

Governance differs from review.

Review evaluates individual artifacts.

Governance evaluates the relationships between artifacts.

Governance capabilities include:

- Detecting contradictory knowledge
- Identifying duplicate teaching
- Maintaining terminology consistency
- Managing knowledge relationships
- Validating curriculum coverage
- Monitoring evidence sufficiency
- Managing publication dependencies
- Maintaining editorial standards
- Recording governance decisions
- Managing lifecycle transitions

Governance ensures that independently reviewed artifacts collectively form a coherent educational system.

8. Publication

Publication transforms governed knowledge into learner-facing knowledge.

Publication capabilities include:

- Publication readiness assessment
- Dependency validation
- Final editorial approval
- Version publication
- Publication scheduling
- Learner release
- Publication withdrawal
- Publication supersession
- Publication history

Publication represents institutional trust rather than technical deployment.

9. Continuous Improvement

Clinical knowledge is expected to evolve.

Continuous improvement capabilities ensure that publication is never considered the end of editorial work.

These capabilities include:

- Evidence refresh
- Guideline monitoring
- Educational quality improvement
- Learner feedback integration
- Curriculum evolution
- Diagnostic graph refinement
- AI-assisted quality analysis
- Editorial analytics
- Knowledge retirement
- Knowledge replacement

Continuous improvement transforms WEOS from a publishing system into a living knowledge system.

10. Artificial Intelligence Capabilities

Artificial intelligence functions as an editorial assistant rather than an editorial authority.

AI capabilities include:

Knowledge Generation

Generating candidate educational artifacts.

Knowledge Analysis

Detecting inconsistencies, omissions, duplication, and opportunities for improvement.

Knowledge Recommendation

Suggesting educational improvements without modifying governed knowledge.

Knowledge Quality Assessment

Providing confidence estimates and quality projections for editorial consideration.

Editorial Assistance

Supporting editors during authoring, review, and governance activities.

AI capabilities always operate within human editorial governance.

AI contributes recommendations.

Editors make decisions.

11. Editorial Capability Dependencies

Capabilities are interconnected.

Certain capabilities depend upon the successful completion of others.

For example:

A clinical case cannot be meaningfully reviewed before it exists.

Publication cannot occur before governance.

Governance depends upon review.

Review depends upon authored knowledge.

Knowledge creation depends upon diagnosis registration.

These dependencies define the progression of editorial work while allowing iterative refinement where appropriate.

12. Capability Principles

Every editorial capability should satisfy the following principles.

Capability Independence

Capabilities should remain conceptually independent even when sharing implementation.

Capability Composability

Capabilities should combine to form larger editorial workflows without duplication.

Capability Explainability

Editors should understand why each capability exists.

Capability Auditability

Every meaningful editorial action should produce an auditable outcome.

Capability Extensibility

New capabilities should integrate naturally into the editorial operating model without requiring architectural redesign.

13. Capability Maturity

Capabilities mature over time.

Within WEOS, every capability progresses through four stages.

Foundational

The capability exists conceptually.

Operational

Editors can actively perform the capability.

Governed

The capability participates fully in editorial governance.

Intelligent

The capability proactively assists editors through recommendations, dependency analysis, and quality assessment.

The long-term objective of WEOS is not merely operational capability.

It is editorial intelligence.

14. The Capability Architecture

Editorial capabilities operate upon the Editorial Domain Model to continuously improve governed clinical knowledge.

Editorial Domain

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Editorial Capability

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Editorial Decision

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Governed Knowledge

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Learner Experience

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Editorial Feedback

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Knowledge Improvement

This progression represents the operational heart of WEOS.

Closing Principle

The purpose of WEOS is not to provide software features.

Its purpose is to enable the continuous creation, governance, publication, and improvement of trustworthy clinical knowledge.

Every implementation decision should strengthen one or more editorial capabilities.

Capabilities—not user interface components—define the enduring architecture of the Wardle Editorial Operating System.